

People's participation and representation is necessary to ensure controlled planning, availability and maintenance of a quality health scheme. To ensure high standards and transparency the NRHM is encouraging participation of the people and the local representatives.

Chief Minister, Ashok Chavan



Healthcare for all is a promise of this government

The government has been pro-active in planning immediate measures for the recent Swine flu epidemic and has charted out a slew of activities to generate awareness amongst people to control the crisis, in coming months.

Other on going Programmes:

- Program for control of blindness
- Revised National Tuberculosis Control
- Free Treatment on tuberculosis
- National Leprosy Eradication Programme

provide trade revenue for entrepreneurial groups of women.

The municipal corporations and councils have also been advised to give priority to women self help group (SHG) for a contract basis business.

To protect women and to ensure that they can fearlessly strive for their independence, the government has implemented the Domestic Violence Protection Act and instituted 12 special courts to safe guard their interests.

With such a strong support the SHGs have now ventured into areas such as rural cleanliness, literacy, diagnostic tests, plantation activity and transportation.

Other schemes for women:

- Special Health programmes for women above 40.
- All public places to have toilets for women, within 3 years.
- Retrospective effect to government orders regarding joint ownership in name of husband and wife on all house plots and flats allotted by government.
- Legislation to be introduced for ownership rights for wife in house property acquired by husband.

Women & Child Welfare

The government has initiated various schemes with a total outflow of Rs. 1522 crore, keeping in mind the interests of women.

To ensure that women empower themselves, a 33%

reservation for women has been made mandatory in local self government bodies.

Various self help groups have been set up by Maharashtra government. There are a total of 2,08,416 SHG's today. Out of these 1,68,874 are exclusive women SHG's. It is encouraging that 46,005 women SHG's have started small commercial ventures.

The Mahila Arthik Vikas Mandal (MAVIM) of the government supports these SHG's by providing a variety of opportunity to rural women and empowers them financially. Mainly these schemes help women through their own labour and talent such as craft, embroidery or

by initiating small groups wherein women are trained for particular product production such as pickles, papad, that can be further aided by bank. The government ensures loans to the SHG's at an effective rate of 4% while it compensates the rest to the bank. This is an unique scheme from the Government of Maharashtra.

The Swarna Jayanti Gram Swaroggar Yojana helps the women to sell their products in state market outlets at the district and tehsil level. Additionally urban development bodies are given grants to



Empowering women to strengthen the state

Agriculture

The Maharashtra government aims to improve the farmer's living conditions. The state aims to provide an impetus to them to increase production

and thus enable them to increase their income.

As a part of the slew of initiatives to achieve this goal, the government has waived farm loan worth Rs. 6,208 crore providing relief to 40.15 lakh farmers in the state who were not covered by the central government's Rs. 7800 crore share of the state's farm loan waiver, which covered 38 lakh farmers of Maharashtra.

Elaborating on the scheme, Chief Minister Ashok Chavan said that loans up to Rs 20,000 of all farmers who have less than 5 acres of land would be waived completely. Other farmers who have more than 5 acres have benefitted under the one time settlement scheme. The Rs. 500 crore loan that was drawn for lift irrigation has been waived.

The state has recorded an all time high in food grain production in 2007-08, clocking a record 155.72 Lakh MT. It was followed with a bumper 75.44 Lakh Bale Cotton Crop. The National Food Security Mission has been put in place across 24



Stoop to conquer a bountiful harvest